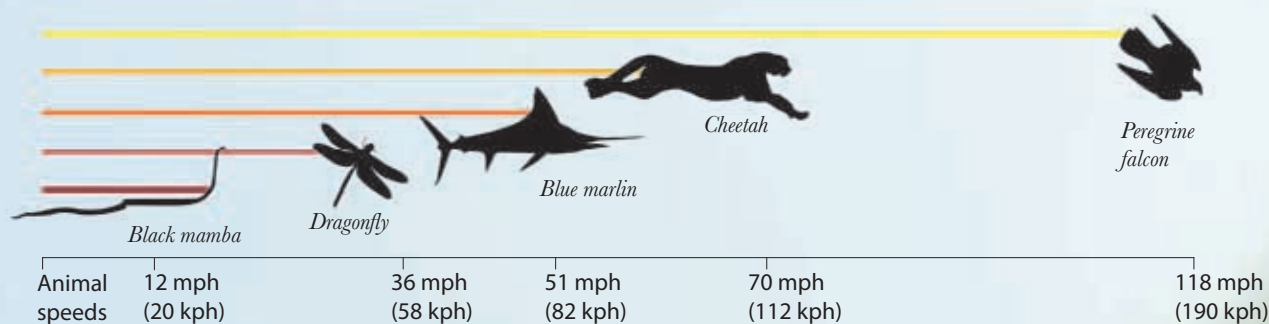




High-speed attacks

Predators that hunt out in the open need to be fast to catch their prey. The fastest of all is the peregrine falcon, which preys on other birds by dive-bombing, or stooping, them in midair. The blue marlin is one of the fastest lone hunters in the water, while the cheetah is the fastest predator on land.



Wing feather has soft fringes that muffle sound

Silent swoop

Despite its impressive wingspan, the great gray owl is an almost silent hunter. It lives in the northern forests of Europe, North America, and Asia and feeds on small rodents, swooping down from the trees on its unsuspecting victims. In the winter, the great gray owl catches prey in the snow. The bird has extremely sensitive hearing, and it can even home in on rodents hiding below the surface, using its weight to punch its way through the frozen crust.

Forest stalker

Like most members of the cat family, the jaguar hunts with stealth. Hidden among the trees, the jaguar stalks its prey by watching and listening for signs of movement on the forest floor. The jaguar weighs up to 330 lb (150 kg) and is strong enough to catch deer and alligators, but it also eats smaller animals, including fish, turtles, and birds. Big cats usually kill their prey by grasping their throats and suffocating them, but the jaguar uses its sharp canine teeth to crush its victims' skulls.

